Results of
Korowai Office Hours 2007
Sunday 2nd December

Place	Team No	Team Members	Elapsed Time	Points (Penalty)
1	20	Clive Marsh, Jeff Hall, Alistair Brown	6:51:46	1250
2	13	Bruce Meder, Vivienne Prince, John Paul Lilburne	6:48:06	1240
3	28	Robert Monro, Mick Whittle	6:50:55	1240
4	7	Des O'Regan, Duncan O'Regan, Patrick O'Regan	6:54:03	1180
5	19	Greig Hamilton, Andreas Kacofegitis, Chris Lovell-Smith, Tane Cambridge	6:42:56	1130
6	8	Richard English, Val Rogers, Kathrin Mueller	6:53:49	1090
7	32	Christine Rowe, Jean Cory Wright	6:36:14	1050
8	29	Paul Titus, Jonathan Carr	7:03:20	1030 (40)
9	30	James Dowle, Ben McQueen, David King	6:50:17	1010
10	22	Mark Flintoft, Lee Burbury	6:51:04	1000
11	45	Hugo Young, Harry Young	6:30:37	960
12	4	Alan Holdaway, Maurice Brown	6:41:40	960
13	14	Stuart Payne, Carol Fowler	6:41:07	950
14	18	Phil Bones, Helen Bones, Andy Buchanan	6:57:28	950
15	27	Christy McKessar, Lukas Frei	7:01:50	930 (20)
16	12	Brian Aitken, Hugh Robinson, Mike Bykerk	6:41:02	920
17	5	Keith Murray, Charlie Murray, Craig Murray	6:54:25	920
18	10	Jacob de Lacey, Daniel Barnfield	6:59:05	920
19	25	Conal Boland Bristow, Tim Farrant, Toby Nielsen	7:08:18	920 (90)
20	11	Tim Jowett, Jodie Ludwig, Shane Green, Raphaelle Cardyn	6:53:31	910
21	3	Peter Squires, Anne Kennedy, Bill Kennedy	6:53:27	890
22	41	Tim Sikma, Clare McLennan	6:36:58	880
23	37	Matt McKessar, Josh Vlaanderen	6:53:11	860
24	36	Vicki Conradson, Rory Jones, Jane Jones	7:03:28	840 (40)
25	34	Wayne Millow, Trevor Merrifield, Bertie Degraaff	6:54:24	820
26	42	Douglas Woods, Hank van Til	6:32:12	810
27	16	Rowan Nugteren, Josiah Lilburne	6:52:25	780
28	21	Iain McGowan, Sarah Wilson	6:46:38	740
29	43	Steve McKinstry, Anna Balfour	6:30:13	730
30	2	Sandra Flamank, Terry Connolly	6:12:39	720
31	17	Caroline Turner, David Elkington	6:22:05	710
32	1	Lisa Nicholl, Grant Bowers	6:40:05	660
33	31	Sonia Mellish, Diane Mellish, Phaedra Upton	6:39:41	650
34	24	Frances Wall, Jenny Maclaren, Sarah Sinton	6:58:12	650
35	40	Martin Etherington, Sharon Govenlock	6:23:16	630
36	44	Piers Maclaren, Bruce Manley	6:43:57	610
37	33	Pat McIntosh, Calum McIntosh	6:20:51	600
38	9	Peter Smith, Joel Smith, Rob van der Salm, Luke van der Salm	6:35:48	600
39	6	Raewyn Moss, Christina Robb	6:41:32	580
40	26	Josie Boland, Bridget Lester	6:33:18	550
41	35	Jude Wilson, Chrys Horn, Kay Booth	6:42:53	530
42	23	Jacqui Todd, James Palmer, Bianca Sullivan	7:04:10	310 (50)

Organiser's comments

One hundred and nine participants in 45 teams seemed to enjoy the 2007 Office Hours rogaine at Torlesse-Korowai Park, beyond Porters Pass. Fortunately, low cloud (= fog) the evening before, and later on event day, did not treat teams too unkindly, with only a few high check points shrouded in fog for parts of the day.

Congratulations to the top 3 teams, a mix of established and new blood, with little to call between them. Team 20, Clive Marsh, Jeff Hall and Alistair Brown share a tramping background in the Christchurch Tramping Club, with a scattering of rogaining and multisport between them. Clive reports: "We guessed that the NW facing slopes of Benmore would have less matagouri than the SE facing valleys leading up to Red Hill etc so chose to go that way …think your pre-rogaine tip of adopting a matagouri avoidance strategy was the key though I've spent almost as much time removing matagouri splinters as I did on the rogaine."

Robert Munro and Mick White form another new team (28), agreeing to team up at the final Front Runner off-road event, where results suggested they were well matched. Robert, out from Scotland a couple of months ago, had done some mountain marathons at home, but made a poor orienteer, he says. Mick he says, previously did not know what a rogaine was. It's great also to see a new generation of Murrays (Team 5) emerging so strongly, so young. (Their published score actually understates check points visited.)

We used this area in 2003 and the plan this year was to invent a new set of route options. However, the extent of regenerating native scrub of prickly varieties limited the scope for this – in a sense we had to go where the openings were. Feedback on the amount and ferocity of scrub on the map was less disparaging than I had expected, which was nice.

Two CPs were problematic. The flag and punch were not in place for 45. Fortunately, the planner's marking tape was, and the location of the CP was fairly decisive so that teams should have wasted little time searching. As far as we have so far determined (the placer having since transhipped to China!), the CP was placed a week earlier and somehow disappeared between then and the event. Points were awarded to those who confirmed they visited 45.

CP 21 was more enigmatic, apparently placed cryptically enough to trip many teams. We apologise to teams affected by this. It's not always easy in an open and large-scaled landscape such as this to strike the balance between CPs not being visible over long distances and not being too hidden by a local feature. We have not awarded points to those who spent time searching fruitlessly for 21.

This was our first use of OCAD software for producing the rogaine map (though OCAD has been used by orienteering clubs for years). Rogainer and orienteer Michael Smithson has produced software that sucks layers of topographical map data from the LINZ database and imports them into OCAD, where a new map can be created layer by layer. Dave Laurie and Bill Kennedy produced the Office Hours map. We've had appreciative feedback on its quality, and especially the 'old people's' scale of 1:25,000. (My goodness, with OCAD and Navlite, rogaining is becoming terrifyingly hi-tech, but we'll stop short of allowing electronic navigation aids for teams.)

Numbers participating were pleasing, up on the previous year, and we're encouraged to do our best to make this a regular feature in the rogaining calendar. Organising an event is a big commitment for all involved, from finding a site (not new for this particular event) through to the final circuit of the course (the 3rd or 4th) to collect the hardware. (Clearly we made it extra hard for ourselves this year, setting a course in which the top teams achieved not much over half of the possible score of 2240). A big thanks to all involved. But it's a satisfying and rewarding task, and we're always keen to hear from any others interested in tackling rogaining from this angle.

Grant Hunter